

Contents

Part I Why Big Data Is Not Smart Yet?

1	Introduction	3
1.1	Motivation	3
1.1.1	What Is Smart Big Data in Digital Agriculture?	5
1.1.2	Plant Physiology-Informed Artificial Intelligence: A New Frontier	6
1.1.3	Big Data Acquisition and Advanced Analytics	9
1.2	The Book Objectives and Methods	9
1.3	Book Contributions	10
1.4	The Book Outline	11
	References	12
2	Why Do Big Data and Machine Learning Entail the Fractional Dynamics?	15
2.1	Fractional Calculus (FC) and Fractional-Order Thinking (FOT)	15
2.2	Complexity and Inverse Power Laws (IPLs)	16
2.3	Heavy-Tailed Distributions	19
2.3.1	Lévy Distribution	19
2.3.2	Mittag–Leffler Distribution	20
2.3.3	Weibull Distribution	20
2.3.4	Cauchy Distribution	21
2.3.5	Pareto Distribution	21
2.3.6	The α -Stable Distribution	21
2.3.7	Mixture Distributions	22
2.4	Big Data, Variability, and FC	22
2.4.1	Hurst Parameter, fGn, and fBm	24
2.4.2	Fractional Lower-Order Moments (FLOMs)	26
2.4.3	Fractional Autoregressive Integrated Moving Average (FARIMA) and Gegenbauer Autoregressive Moving Average (GARMA)	26

- 2.4.4 Continuous-Time Random Walk (CTRW) 27
 - 2.4.5 Unmanned Aerial Vehicles (UAVs) and Digital Agriculture 27
 - 2.5 Optimal Machine Learning and Optimal Randomness 28
 - 2.5.1 Derivative-Free Methods 30
 - 2.5.2 The Gradient-Based Methods 31
 - 2.6 What Can the Control Community Offer to ML? 33
 - 2.7 Case Study: Optimal Randomness for Stochastic Configuration Network (SCN) with Heavy-Tailed Distributions .. 39
 - 2.7.1 Introduction 39
 - 2.7.2 SCN with Heavy-Tailed PDFs 41
 - 2.7.3 A Regression Model and Parameter Tuning..... 41
 - 2.7.4 MNIST Handwritten Digit Classification 43
 - 2.8 Chapter Summary 45
 - References 47

Part II Smart Big Data Acquisition Platforms

- 3 Small Unmanned Aerial Vehicles (UAVs) and Remote Sensing Payloads 57**
 - 3.1 The UAV Platform 57
 - 3.2 Lightweight Sensors 59
 - 3.2.1 RGB Camera..... 59
 - 3.2.2 Multispectral Camera..... 60
 - 3.2.3 The Short Wave Infrared Camera 60
 - 3.2.4 Thermal Camera 60
 - 3.3 UAV Image Acquisition and Processing 61
 - 3.3.1 Flight Mission Design 61
 - 3.3.2 UAV Image Processing 62
 - 3.4 Challenges and Opportunities 63
 - 3.4.1 UAVs 64
 - 3.4.2 UAV Path Planning and Image Processing 65
 - 3.4.3 Pre-flight Path Planning 65
 - 3.4.4 Multispectral Image Calibration 65
 - 3.4.5 Thermal Camera Calibration and Image Processing 67
 - 3.4.6 Images Stitching and Orthomosaic Image Generation 68
 - 3.5 Case Study: High Spatial Resolution Has Little Impact on NDVI Mean Value of UAV-Based Individual Tree-level Mapping: Evidence from Nine Field Tests and Implications 69
 - 3.5.1 Introduction 69
 - 3.5.2 Material and Methods 70
 - 3.5.3 Results and Discussion 72
 - 3.5.4 Conclusions and Future Work..... 77
 - 3.6 Chapter Summary 78
 - References 78

4	The Edge-AI Sensors and Internet of Living Things (IoLT)	83
4.1	Introduction	83
4.2	Proximate Sensors	84
4.2.1	The Spectrometer	84
4.2.2	A Pocket-Sized Spectrometer	84
4.2.3	A Microwave Radio Frequency 3D Sensor	85
4.3	Case Study: Onion Irrigation Treatment Inference Using a Low-Cost Edge-AI Sensor	87
4.3.1	Introduction	87
4.3.2	Materials and Methods	88
4.3.3	Results and Discussion	92
4.3.4	Conclusion and Future Work	94
4.4	Chapter Summary	95
	References	95
5	The Unmanned Ground Vehicles (UGVs) for Digital Agriculture	99
5.1	Introduction	99
5.2	UGV as Data Acquisition Platform	101
5.2.1	Fundamental Research Questions	101
5.2.2	Low Barriers to Entry	102
5.2.3	Cognitive Algorithms by Deep Learning	104
5.2.4	Swarming Mechanism of UGVs	104
5.3	Case Study: Build a UGV Platform for Agricultural Research from a Low-Cost Toy Vehicle	105
5.3.1	Introduction	105
5.4	Chapter Summary	106
	References	107
 Part III Advanced Big Data Analytics, Plant Physiology-Informed Machine Learning, and Fractional-Order Thinking		
6	Fundamentals of Big Data, Machine Learning, and Computer Vision Workflow	113
6.1	Introduction	113
6.2	A Fundamental Tutorial: Cotton Water Stress Classification with CNN	116
6.2.1	Data Loading	116
6.2.2	Data Preprocessing	117
6.2.3	Train and Test Split	120
6.2.4	Creating the Model	122
6.2.5	The Model Performance Evaluation	126
6.3	Chapter Summary	128
	References	128

7	A Low-Cost Proximate Sensing Method for Early Detection of Nematodes in Walnut Using Machine Learning Algorithms	129
7.1	Introduction	129
7.2	Materials and Methods	131
7.2.1	Study Area	131
7.2.2	Reflectance Measurements with a Radio Frequency Sensor	133
7.2.3	Ground Truth Data Collection and Processing	133
7.2.4	Scikit-Learn Classification Algorithms	135
7.2.5	Deep Neural Networks (DNNs) and TensorFlow	136
7.3	Results and Discussion	136
7.3.1	Data Visualization (Project 45, 2019)	136
7.3.2	Performance of Classifiers (Project 45, 2019)	137
7.3.3	Performance of Classifiers (Project 45, 2020)	141
7.4	Chapter Summary	145
	References	145
8	Tree-Level Evapotranspiration Estimation of Pomegranate Trees Using Lysimeter and UAV Multispectral Imagery	149
8.1	Introduction	149
8.2	Materials and Methods	154
8.2.1	Study Site Description	154
8.2.2	UAV Image Collection and Processing	155
8.3	Results and Discussion	156
8.3.1	Determination of Individual Tree K_c from NDVI	156
8.3.2	The Spatial Variability Mapping of K_c and ET_c	156
8.3.3	Performance of the Individual Tree-Level ET Estimation	158
8.4	Conclusion	158
8.5	Summary	160
	References	160
9	Individual Tree-Level Water Status Inference Using High-Resolution UAV Thermal Imagery and Complexity-Informed Machine Learning	165
9.1	Introduction	165
9.2	Materials and Methods	167
9.2.1	Experimental Site and Irrigation Management	167
9.2.2	Ground Truth: Infrared Canopy and Air Temperature	168
9.2.3	Thermal Infrared Remote Sensing Data	168
9.2.4	Complexity-Informed Machine Learning (CIML)	170
9.2.5	Principle of Tail Matching	171
9.2.6	Machine Learning Classification Algorithms	172
9.3	Results and Discussion	173
9.3.1	Comparison of Canopy Temperature Per Tree Based on Ground Truth and UAV Thermal Imagery	173

9.3.2	The Relationship Between ΔT and Irrigation Treatment	174
9.3.3	The Classification Performance of CIML on Irrigation Treatment Levels	174
9.4	Summary	175
	References	178
10	Scale-Aware Pomegranate Yield Prediction Using UAV Imagery and Machine Learning	181
10.1	Introduction	181
10.2	Materials and Methods	183
10.2.1	Experimental Field and Ground Data Collection	183
10.2.2	UAV Platform and Imagery Data Acquisition	183
10.2.3	UAV Image Feature Extraction	185
10.2.4	The Machine Learning Methods	187
10.3	Results and Discussion	188
10.3.1	The Pomegranate Yield Performance in 2019	188
10.3.2	The Correlation Between the Image Features and Pomegranate Yield	188
10.3.3	The ML Algorithm Performance on Yield Estimation	189
10.4	Summary	192
	References	194
Part IV Towards Smart Big Data in Digital Agriculture		
11	Intelligent Bugs Mapping and Wiping (iBMW): An Affordable Robot-Driven Robot for Farmers	199
11.1	Introduction	199
11.2	Existing Solutions	200
11.3	iBMW Innovation	202
11.3.1	Cognitive of Pest Population Mapping and Wiping	203
11.3.2	iBMW with TurtleBot 3 as “Brain”	204
11.3.3	Real-Time Vision Processing	204
11.3.4	Optimal Path Planning Enabled by iBMW	206
11.3.5	Ethical, Cultural, and Legal Matters	207
11.4	Measuring Success	207
11.4.1	NOW Population Temporal and Spatial Distribution	207
11.4.2	The Amount of Pesticide Being Used	208
11.4.3	The Target Trees’ Almond Yield	208
11.5	Summary	208
	References	209
12	A Non-invasive Stem Water Potential Monitoring Method Using Proximate Sensor and Machine Learning Classification Algorithms	211
12.1	Introduction	211

12.2	Materials and Methods	212
12.2.1	Walnut Study Area	212
12.2.2	Reflectance Measurements with a Radio Frequency Sensor	212
12.2.3	Data Collection and Processing	214
12.2.4	Scikit-Learn Classification Algorithms	214
12.3	Results and Discussion	215
12.4	Summary	217
	References	217
13	A Low-Cost Soil Moisture Monitoring Method by Using Walabot and Machine Learning Algorithms	219
13.1	Introduction	219
13.2	Materials and Methods	221
13.2.1	The Study Site	221
13.2.2	The Proximate Sensor	221
13.2.3	Experiment Setup	222
13.2.4	Data Collection and Processing	222
13.3	Results and Discussion	224
13.3.1	Linear Discriminant Analysis Performance	225
13.3.2	Principal Component Analysis Performance	227
13.4	Summary	228
	References	229
14	Conclusion and Future Research	231
14.1	Concluding Remarks	231
14.2	Future Research Toward Smart Big Data in Digital Agricultural Applications	232
	Index	235